DESMI 2026 - MIKE CASTRO DEMARIA

SURVIVE THE QUARTER

You are the new marketing manager of Croissant Rocket, croissants delivered by drone. Ten days of chaos, two gauges, and one way to get fired: let either of them hit zero.

Final project, Python for Digital Marketing, M1

THE STORY

Croissant Rocket is a start-up that delivers croissants by drone. You just got the marketing job.

Every day, something happens: your CEO tweets at 3 a.m., a cat influencer wants a deal, a drone drops a croissant on a food critic. You pick **A, B or C**, and every choice moves two gauges.

Hit zero on either gauge: **you are fired**. Survive ten days: you get a title, from **Eternal Intern** to **Viral Legend**.

Your job today: **build this game in Python.**

BUDGET

10,000 EUR

REPUTATION

50 / 100

Spend everything to please everyone, the bank says no. Save every euro, the internet hates you. Balance wins.

WHAT YOU WILL PRACTISE

01

READ AN EXTERNAL FILE

Load your group's scenario file with the `csv` module. Turn text into numbers when you need to compute.

02

WORK WITH TUPLES

Store each option as a tuple, return tuples from functions, unpack them, compare them.

03

WRITE AN EXTERNAL FILE

Append one line per game to `results.csv`, so every player leaves a trace.

And along the way, everything you have seen so far: **lists, a dictionary,** `for`**,** `while`**,** `if / elif`**,** `break`**, functions,** `random`**.**

PROVIDED MATERIAL

- **One file per group**: `scenarios_A.csv`, `_B` or `_C`. **Use only yours.** The three are built differently: code written for another group's file will not run on yours.
- Nobody describes the file for you, **not even your AI assistant**: reading it is part of the exercise.
- **No starter code.** You write `survive_the_quarter.py` from an empty file.
- **Where:** GitHub Codespaces (recommended) or Python on your laptop.

YOUR FIRST FIVE MINUTES

Open `scenarios_X.csv` (your letter) before you write a single line.

- Which separator?
- How many columns, what does each hold?
- How are the numbers written?
- How do you find the impact of option B?

WHAT YOUR GAME MUST DO

DURING THE GAME

1. Ask the player's name
2. Load every scenario from your group's file
3. Shuffle them and play 10 days
4. Each day, show the day number, both gauges, the situation and options A, B, C
5. Ask for A, B or C. Ask again until the answer is valid (a, b, c accepted)
6. Apply the budget and reputation impact of the choice, show its feedback line
7. Reputation can never go above 100
8. Budget or reputation at 0 or less: game over, the game stops at once

AT THE END

9. Show the result: fired (and why), or the final title
10. Show the best and the worst move of the game
11. Append one line to `results.csv`: name, budget, reputation, title, date

THE RULES IN NUMBERS

SETTING	VALUE
Starting budget	**10,000 EUR**
Starting reputation	**50** (maximum 100)
Days per game	**10**
Fired when	budget or reputation **≤ 0**

Final score, only if you survive:

```
score = reputation + budget // 200
```

SCORE	TITLE
a gauge at 0	**Fired**
under 95	**Eternal Intern**
95 to 119	**Growth Hacker**
120 to 139	**CMO Material**
140 and more	**Viral Legend**

Best and worst move: the days with the biggest and the smallest reputation change.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

```
--- Day 4 ---
[Budget: 8200 EUR | Reputation: 65/100]
A cat influencer with 2 million followers wants
to review your croissants.
  A: Pay the cat 2,000 EUR
  B: Send free croissants, no fee
  C: Decline: "we don't work with cats"
Your choice (A, B or C): d
Please type A, B or C: a
The cat licks one croissant. Sales explode.
Budget -2000 EUR, Reputation +20
```

```
==============================
Quarter survived!
Budget left: 6350 EUR, reputation: 100/100
Final score: 131
Lea, your title: CMO Material

Best move:  day 4, "Pay the cat 2,000 EUR" (+20)
Worst move: day 7, "Ignore it" (-10)
Saved in results.csv
```

Your wording and layout can differ. **The behaviour cannot.**

TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

- Read and write with the `csv` **module**. No pandas, nothing to install. Only your group's file.
- Each option is stored as a **tuple**: `(text, budget_change, reputation_change, feedback)`
- At least one function **returns a tuple**, and you unpack it: `budget, reputation = apply_choice(...)`
- Keep a **history**: a list with one tuple per day. Use it to find the best and the worst move. *Hint: Python compares tuples element by element, starting with the first.*
- At least **four functions**, one job each, with a name that says what it does.
- Runs with `python survive_the_quarter.py`, **without crashing, whatever the player types.**

BEFORE YOU ASK AN AI ANYTHING

Start your file with a comment holding **your first and last name and your group letter**. Then answer these four questions as **comments, in your own words**. This is where building a program starts, and where pasting one ends.

1. **What goes in?** Describe your scenario file: the separator, the columns, what they hold, how the numbers are written.
2. **What happens?** The steps of one day, in order, one line each.
3. **What comes out?** What the player sees at the end, and what one line of `results.csv` looks like.
4. **What could go wrong?** At least three things (a wrong key, a gauge below zero, a missing file…) and what your program does about each.

MAKE IT YOURS

MANDATORY 1: THREE SCENARIOS OF YOUR OWN

Add 3 situations at the end of your scenario file (numbers 31 to 33), **in the same format as the rest of the file**: your story, your jokes, your numbers. They must appear in your game like the others.

MANDATORY 2: ONE FEATURE, YOUR CHOICE

Say at the top of your file which one you chose, and why.

	FEATURE
a	**Streak bonus**: three reputation gains in a row give +500 EUR
b	**The algorithm**: on one random day, the reputation change is doubled
c	**High score**: at the end, read `results.csv` and say whether the player beat the best budget
d	**Difficulty**: ask at the start, easy (15,000 EUR) or hard (6,000 EUR)

DELIVERABLES

FILE	CONTENT
`survive_the_quarter.py`	Your game. At the top, in comments: **your first and last name and your group letter**, then the four answers and your feature choice. A comment above each block, in your own words
`scenarios_X.csv`	Your group's file, with your three scenarios added
`results.csv`	At least three games played
AI log (Word or PDF)	Your full conversation with the AI: what you asked, what it answered, what you had to fix. Paste as you go

Submission on Teams, at the end of the session. Not one extra minute.

IF YOU DO NOT FINISH

An incomplete game that runs beats a complete one that crashes.

1. **Make it run.** Comment out the part that crashes, so the rest still works.
2. **Say what is missing**, at the top of your file: what you did not finish, and how you would have done it.
3. **Hand in anyway.** An empty submission is a zero.

Never paste a long script from an AI in the last five minutes. It always shows.

GOOD LUCK, LIL JEDI

May your budget stay positive and your reputation viral.